

REQUIREMENT GATHERING

Date: 15/07/25

1. Project Overview:

TravelEase Hub is a full-stack web application designed to streamline and personalize travel planning. It solves the problem of limited flexibility, lack of real-time collaboration, and absence of personalized planning in current travel systems. The platform provides AI-generated itineraries, smart package search, booking management, budget estimation, expense splitting, and pooling options to enhance group travel experiences.

2. System Scope:

The system is proposed as a full-scale implementation, likely beginning as a prototype with features that support real-world use cases such as user registration, booking, itinerary generation, and pooling.

3. Target Audience:

- A. Travellers/Users: Individuals planning personal or group trips.
- B. Travel Agencies: Entities offering travel packages and promotions.
- C. Administrators: System managers handling backend tasks and verifications.

4. Modules:

- A. User Module:
 - Login/Register
 - Smart Package Search
 - AI Itinerary Planner

- Booking Management
- Budget Estimator
- Map Integration
- Trip History & Reviews
- User Pooling System
- Smart Expense Splitting

B. Agency Module:

- Secure Login/Register
- Travel Package Management
- Booking Alerts

C. Admin Module:

- User/Agency Account Management
- Travel Package Verification
- System Notifications

5. User Roles:

- A. User: Can search, plan, and book travel packages, view itinerary and history.
- B. Agency: Manages package listings and receives bookings.
- C. Admin: Controls the overall system, manages users/agencies, and verifies listings.

6. System Ownership:

The TravelEase Hub system is owned and operated by an independent developer or organization, with the intention of deploying it as a real-world travel assistance platform. The ownership includes full rights to the application, its data handling processes, business logic, and revenue generation. The system is designed for commercial use and aims to serve the travel and tourism industry at scale, including end users and travel agencies.

7. Industry/Domain:

Tourism and Travel Technology

8. Data Collection Contacts:

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9. Questionnaire for Data Collection:

- What are the current challenges you face in finding compatible travel partners and coordinating travel arrangements?

The gradual method of partner selection that depends on matching users according to similar interests together with their past travel records requires extensive manual work.

- How do you currently search for and book tour packages, and what improvements would you like to see in this process?

The user now understands inefficiency when they need to search for tour packages on various platforms, since they have to manually compare prices. The user gets frustrated since the system only gives them generic packages. The system also fails to incorporate features like pairing partners into the booking.

- What features would you find most useful in a tour package booking system?

The most important functionality includes trip package recommendations and matching platform tools for partners that have a user-friendly booking interface.

- What are the common difficulties that users face while planning group trips?

Splitting and managing group bills is usually done manually, and platforms rarely offer built-in tools to simplify this process.

- Would users prefer AI-generated itineraries or manual customization?

They usually like AI-generated itineraries valuable because it saves them time and provides a good starting point.

- Are users interested in pooling travel with others to reduce costs?

Absolutely, many users, especially solo travellers, students, or selective travellers are very interested in pooling features. Pooling enables travel to a shared destination to be shared by travellers in terms of transportation, accommodation, or activity costs, making it more affordable and on occasion more enjoyable through socialization.

- What are the top filters users prefer while searching for travel packages?

When searching for travel packages, users generally filter by destination, budget, duration of the trip, and travel dates.

- In your opinion, how can system notifications improve the experience for both your agency and your customers?

Definitely, system notifications can make a big difference for us. If we receive immediate alerts when a customer makes a booking or sends an inquiry, we can reply quicker, which is trust-building and enhances our service. Sometimes, delays in responding can cause us to lose potential customers. Also, if the customer receives timely updates about their booking status, payment reminders, or changes in travel plans, it avoids a lot of confusion.

- How do you currently receive and manage customer bookings?
Is it manual or digital?

Currently, the majority of our reservations are made over the phone, via WhatsApp, or through social media requests. A digital system with automated booking logs and reminders would really help us avoid errors and save time.

- Do you currently use any other digital platforms or tools to manage your travel business?

Not really. We mostly depend on WhatsApp, Google Sheets, and some basic email templates.